

value to it by including rare and unpublished photographs and documents.

S. BALAKRISHNAN, *Jamshedpur*

Tribute to the Martyrs

I am co-pilot Sheldon L. Chambers's niece. My uncle was on board the B-24J "Hot as Hell" aircraft that crashed in India ("Ghosts of War", February 11). This was the best article I have read on the crash of this aircraft. The families of the nine crew members are grateful for whatever has been done by the magazine and the Indian Government for them.

JOYCE C. DOUGAL, *on e-mail*

I want to thank INDIA TODAY for the wonderful article. It gave us a human account of the life of my grandfather Eugene Oxford, a bombardier in the aircraft, who was like a character from one of the fairy-tales for me.

BRYAN SMITH,

North Carolina, USA

Justice at Last

Bilkis Bano has been an unforgettable face of the Gujarat riots ("Delayed But Not Denied", February 4). Now that face—apart from being a reminder of the remorseless cruelty man can inflict on another—will also stand testimony to what courage and dogged determination can achieve.

MEGHANA A., *Hyderabad*

It is a matter of pride to see Bano get justice. This was made possible by the united stand taken by the country against the perpetrators of the crime. However, it is a matter of great concern that the same country has been silent on the plight of the

Kashmiri Pandits who have been forced to live like refugees on their own soil.

RAMESH AGARWAL, *Kanpur*

The Last Gentleman

It is doubtful that any other skipper apart from Anil Kumble could have handled the crisis that cricket and the Indian team went through in Australia in such a graceful manner ("Ascent of the Titan", February 4). It is men like Kumble who make the country proud.

B.H. AGARWAL, *Bhopal*

Politics of Protection

Power-hungry politicians who demand gun-toting brigades are the biggest jokers on earth ("Perception of Threat", January 28).

RAVI BEDI, *Jodhpur*

Correction

Anju Dodiya's show will be held at the Bodhi Art Gallery, not the Tao Art Gallery as was mentioned in the write-up "Sacred Feminine" (February 18). The error is regretted.

WEAK COMMAND



Occasional lip service to our soldiers by politicians and denial of the legitimate dues of serving and retired officers by the government clearly exposes its "I-don't-give-a-damn" attitude towards its people ("The Missing Officers", February 4).

VARSHA SINGH, *Pune*

The article exposes the disgraceful attitude of our society—till now been hidden under the glittering carpet of emerging modern culture—towards the army.

C. SHAMASUNDAR, *Bangalore*

It would be better if the army chief before advocating conscription, took note of the fact that there are 60 lakh beggars in India, of which 66 per cent are able-bodied ("Beggars' Banquet", February 4). Why not recruit these unemployed in the army?

V. SIVAGNANAM, *Kalpakkam*

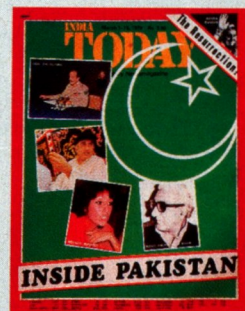
Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

e-mail your letters to: letters.editor@intoday.com
or fax them to: 011-23316180

30

Years Ago in India Today

MARCH 1-15, 1978



A Nation Adrift

Often, in Pakistan, the choice of who will rule the country begins and ends with its best-known politician, and premier of seven years, who now languishes in a Lahore jail: Zulfikar Ali Bhutto. With him in jail, his wife Nusrat and daughter Benazir have emerged as the stalwarts of PPP: they lead agitations, they are detained,



placed under Zulfikar Bhutto house arrest, released and re-arrested. On December 18, 1977, Begum Bhutto led an agitation at the Gadaffi stadium in Lahore during the Pakistan vs MCC cricket match, was badly injured, hospitalised, and later detained by the police. On her release, she emerged triumphant with the halo of martyrdom. The Bhutto cult is not easily extinguished, particularly in Punjab and parts of Sind, where he still has massive support, mainly amongst the peasantry and the working class.

—Sunil Sethi

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE CALL: (95120) 2479900 from DELHI and FARIDABAD; (0120) 2479900 from REST OF INDIA; Fax (0120) 4078080 KOLKATA; Tel 22821922, 22827726, 22825398 Fax 22825398, 22827254 BANGALORE; Tel 2212448, 2290562, 2218343 Fax 2218335 MUMBAI; Tel 24444423/4/5/6 Fax 24444358 CHENNAI; Tel 28478525-44 Fax 28472178. FOR CUSTOMER CARE CALL: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines) 120 2479900 (Monday–Friday; 10am–6 pm); WRITE IN: WE CARE, The India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (U.P.)-201301. e-mail: wecare@intoday.com